

A group of Dauntain launch a shock attack on the changelings, armed with cold iron weapons. In an event such as this, dice are required to generate a situation of chance and tension. The Dauntain could be significantly stronger than the changelings if they have the true element of surprise, or weaker if they've underestimated the motley, but the element of chance added by dice rolling adds risk and drama to a conflict situation. In situations like this one, the changelings can fail, get injured, or maybe even die. They can also demolish the opposition, if the dice are in their favor.

The changelings engage in tense negotiations with a fantastical, dangerous chimera of unknowable age and power. This is an example of what would almost certainly be an extended action (see p. 246) or even a resisted action (see p. 247) if the chimera's favor is being contested by other beings, or if it simply dislikes the changelings. The dice in this case not only serve to show how well the negotiations go for the changelings, but also how long the negotiations last. Is the chimera influenced swiftly? How well does the opposing group do in winning the chimera over to their side? Roleplaying should influence the dice in events like these, as convincing arguments, carefully placed bargaining chips, or ham-fisted insults could lower or increase the difficulty target on later challenges within the action.

Actions

Actions are anything a character does that might produce an interesting outcome to the direction of the story. If a changeling is being chased by a chimerical beast, crossing the road safely may become trickier. When a changeling is concealing a dark secret from his motley, talking openly with friends becomes an effort to resist letting the truth slip. If a changeling is succumbing to Banality, having to associate with other changelings could be the most daunting ordeal he can imagine. These are all actions of varying types. One action usually takes one turn to complete. See p. 248 for more information on increments of game time.

Typically, speaking and conversation do not require dice rolls. This freedom from game mechanics only changes in situations where a changeling wishes to use Abilities like Expression or Intimidation. The game places as few limitations as possible on communication among players and characters.

In order to attempt an action, the player must tell the Storyteller what she wants her character to do, and how the character intends to do it. Most actions are simple enough to be automatically successful, but where there's the possibility of failure or an interesting consequence based on how well the character succeeds, dice must be rolled to determine the results.

If only one success is required to accomplish an action, the action is called a simple action. Actions requiring more successes or longer periods of time to complete are called extended actions. See p. 246 for more information on extended actions.

Reflexive Actions

When characters react instinctively, they take a reflexive action. Characters perform reflexive actions automatically, and may take a normal action on a turn without penalty.

Soaking damage from an attack (p. 282) is reflexive, for example. Spending a point of Glamour or Willpower takes less than a second — it doesn't require a dice roll, and a character can do it while focusing on something else.

Characters must be conscious (or otherwise capable of choosing to take the action, in the case of dream sequences or other deviations from consciousness that still allow choice) in order to make a reflexive action. Unless otherwise specified, a character may perform any number of reflexive actions, and they don't prevent any other actions from being taken.

Ratings

A character is defined by her Traits. Traits in **Changeling** are usually rated 1 to 5, the number being the number of "dots" the character has in a Trait. One dot is barely competent; 5 dots is the pinnacle of human achievement, although changelings can surpass this peak through various abilities unique to the Kithain. Most people's Traits range from 1 to 3; with 2 being the human average. A character can have a Trait rating of 0, representing an Ability never learned or a disability rendering an Attribute impossible to use.

x	Abysmal
●	Poor
●●	Average
●●●	Good
●●●●	Exceptional
●●●●●	Superb

Dice Pools

When rolling dice, the player rolls one die for each dot possessed in the appropriate Trait. Innate aptitude is often modified by skill, so the rating of an appropriate Ability adds dice to the pool, resulting in a combination of Attribute dice and Ability dice. A changeling attempting to lie to his motley would roll dice equal to the number of points in Manipulation + Subterfuge, for instance.

A character is deep in his books on engineering, attempting to calculate the materials necessary for building a fantastical flying craft to gift the sidhe baron. The Storyteller might request a roll of Intelligence + Science: an Attribute plus an Ability. In this case, three dice for the Intelligence of 3, plus four in Science, give seven dice in total. A roll of these seven dice determines the character's success or failure in identifying the source and attainability of each component required for the flying machine. These dice are the dice pool: the total number of dice rolled for a single action. Dice pools are typically calculated for one action at a time. Pools can be divided to perform multiple tasks in a turn (for more information, see "Multiple Actions," below).

Some rolls require a roll of an Attribute rating only. For example, lifting an object is a pure application of Strength,